



Local Markets Alert

EM flow dynamics – Risk appetite likely to pick up

- Flow dynamics suggest risk appetite moderated this week; we expect flows to improve in the near term
- EM debt funds extended their inflow streak to a ninth consecutive week, attracting USD 4.5bn
- We expect sentiment towards EM debt and other risky assets to improve as the US rates headwind eases

Receding US rates may support risky-asset inflows

- The latest US inflation data suggests moderating price pressures, likely providing support to risky assets this week. While markets are still pricing in one or more Fed rate hikes over the next 12 months, we see scope for these expectations to unwind further. The prospect of lower US rates and improved risk sentiment on fading Fed hike expectations should support inflows to EM. That said, there is a risk that any rebound in flows could remain skewed towards DM assets.
- Our thematic flow analysis suggests that risk-on sentiment softened ahead of key inflation data releases this week. While inflows to DM HY debt and EM equities moderated, EM debt funds attracted USD 391mn, marking a ninth consecutive week of inflows. Meanwhile, flows into DM equities picked up, supported by better-than-expected earnings and continued enthusiasm around the AI theme.
- EM debt inflows were broad-based across most fund segments. EM HC and blended debt funds led inflows of USD +126mn and USD +82mn, respectively, primarily from institutional investors. QTD, EM HC and blended debt funds have attracted strong inflows, totalling USD 1.7bn (c.+0.7% of AUM) and USD 1.6bn (c.+2.5% of AUM).
- Meanwhile, EM LCY debt funds rebounded to inflows of USD 99mn this week, reversing last week's USD 36mn outflows, with institutional and ETF demand contributing USD +40mn and USD +49mn, respectively.

Foreign investor purchases of LCY debt moderated; they sold THB debt

- Foreign investors turned modest net sellers of EM debt, led by outflows from THB debt. Specifically, long-term (>1Y) THB bonds recorded net foreign selling of USD -171mn, reversing from inflows of USD 300mn last week. Similarly, inflows to most other Asia LCY debt, such as IDR and INR bonds, also slowed. MYR debt saw its highest foreign inflows in eight weeks of a total USD 719mn.
- Lower oil prices, coupled with a more stable USD, likely provided a more supportive backdrop across key Asian LCY markets (see [The Rates Standard – Tactical opportunities](#)). Within Asia, we remain *Positive* on KTBs and *Neutral* elsewhere, as lingering inflation risks in select markets continue to limit upside.

Marcus Ang

+65 6981 0358

MarcusGuoSheng.Ang@sc.com

Flows and Rates Strategist

Standard Chartered Bank (Singapore) Limited

Nagaraj Kulkarni

+65 6981 2712

Nagaraj.Kulkarni@sc.com

Chief Rates Strategist, South Asia &

Indonesia, and Head, Flows Strategy

Standard Chartered Bank (Singapore) Limited

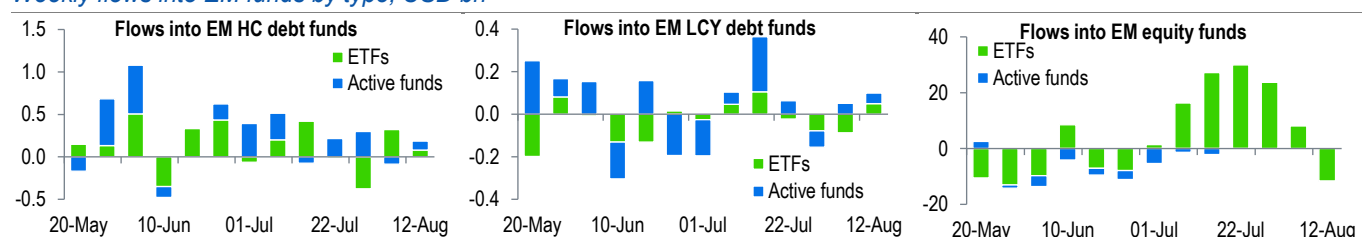
Fund flows dashboard

Week ended 12 August

	This week		Prior week	YTD
Funds	USD mn	% AUM	% AUM	USD mn
EM debt	391	0.10	0.11	24,445
Local	99	0.12	(0.04)	7,412
Blended	107	0.16	0.37	7,275
Hard	185	0.08	0.10	9,758
DM HY debt	414	0.06	0.58	13,452
US	248	0.06	0.84	6,720
Global	(157)	(0.09)	0.11	1,729
Europe	321	0.27	0.35	4,871
DM IG debt	21,968	0.26	0.22	561,799
US	15,599	0.31	0.28	416,662
Global	1,831	0.16	0.15	57,459
Europe	4,245	0.22	0.12	63,024
DM MM	25,230	0.23	0.49	403,882
US	24,407	0.26	0.56	331,977
Europe	823	0.05	0.09	71,905
EM equity	(11,853)	(0.39)	0.29	(44,925)
DM equity	27,938	0.10	0.08	816,271

Source: EPFR Global

Figure 1: EM debt funds saw nine consecutive weeks of inflows; inflows to EM equity ETFs turned to outflows this week
Weekly flows into EM funds by type, USD bn



Source: EPFR, Standard Chartered Research

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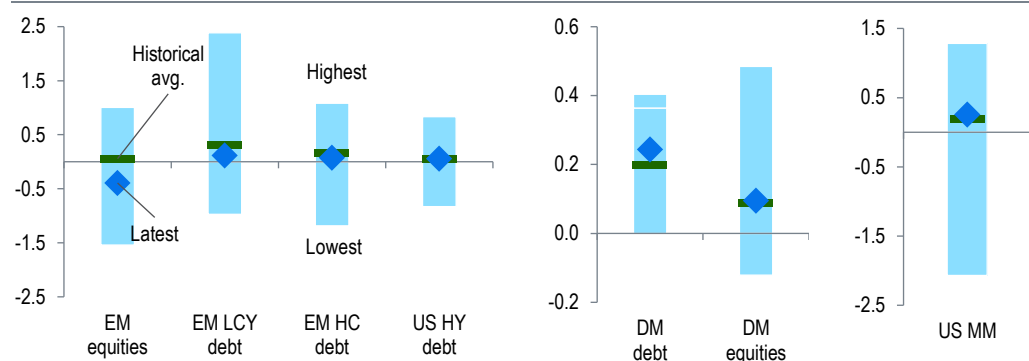
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Summary of fund flow dynamics

Figure 2: Weekly fund flows as % of AUM against rolling one-year average

Flow sentiment favoured DM debt and EM debt over EM equities

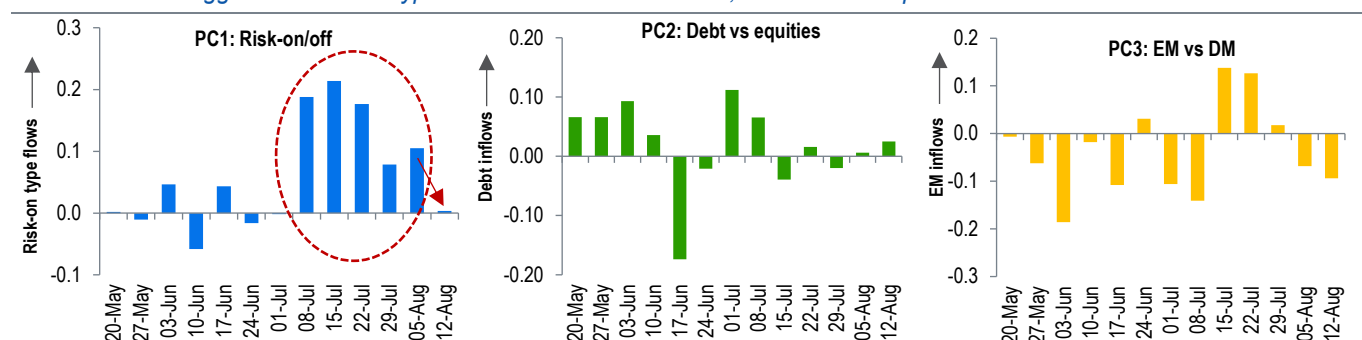
If the latest weekly fund flows (% of AUM) are above historical average, investors' sentiment may have improved; below average suggests weakened sentiment



Source: EPFR, Standard Chartered Research

Figure 3: Flow themes – Principal component analysis (PCA)

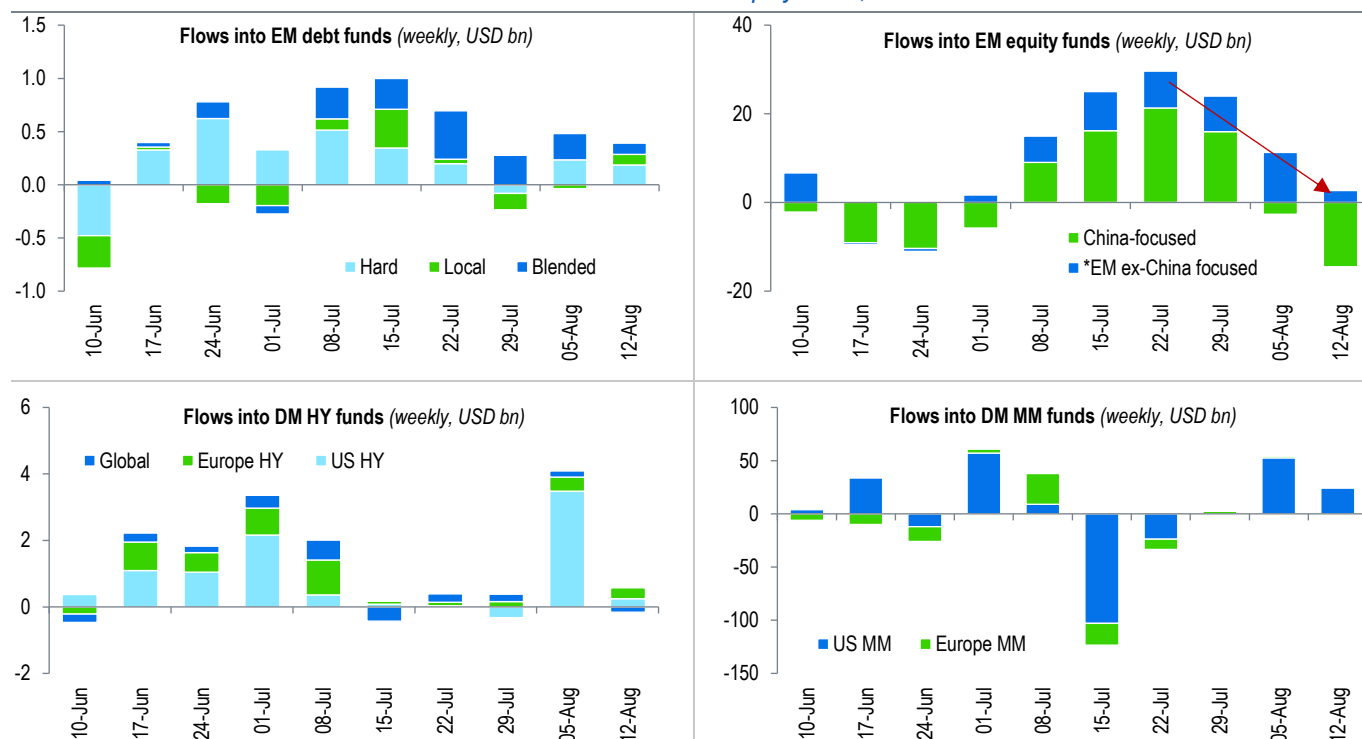
Flow thematics suggest that risk-on type flows moderated this week, with continued preference for DM over EM assets



Source: EPFR, Standard Chartered Research

Figure 4: Risk appetite across various fund asset classes

Inflows to EM debt funds continued but switched to outflows for EM equity funds; flows to DM HY debt funds moderated



*Excludes China-focused funds, includes Global EM (GEM)-focused funds that invest in China; Source: EPFR, Standard Chartered Research

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Overview of foreign buying across EM local markets

Figure 5: Foreign investor flows – EM local bonds

Foreigners sold a significant amount of THB debt

LCY debt markets	WTD	MTD	YTD
	USD mn	USD bn	
MYR#	-	719	(0.6)
ZAR*	(21)	339	(2.4)
INR*	108	219	10.2
IDR	(23)	176	0.9
HUF	2	156	14.1
THB	(217)	102	0.8

*Does not account for redemptions, #includes MGS, MGII, SPK, MTB and MITB; Source: Bloomberg, national sources, Standard Chartered Research

Figure 6: Foreign investor flows – Equities

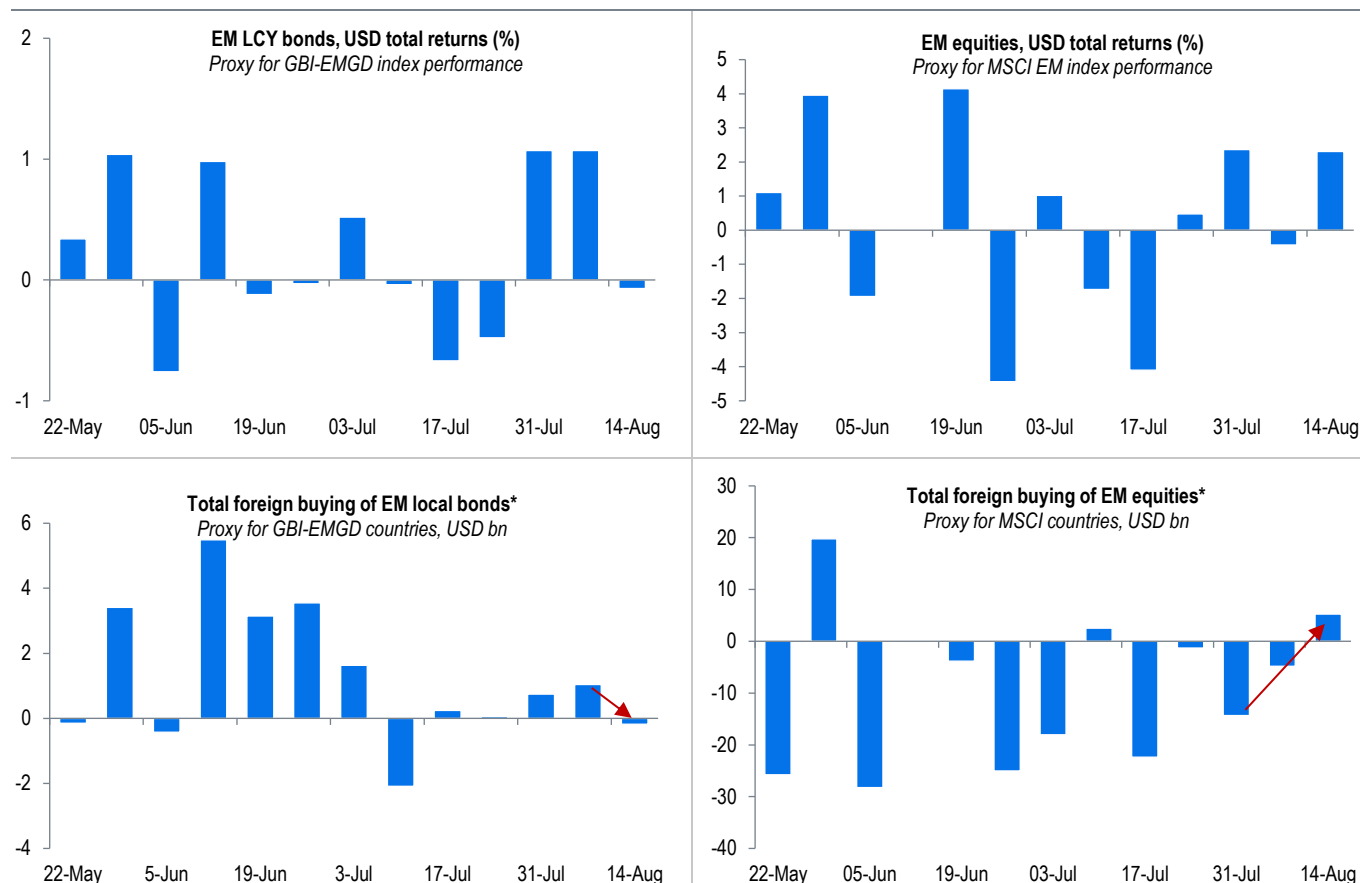
Foreigners bought TWD and KRW equities, sold CNY equities

Equity markets	WTD	MTD	YTD
	USD mn	USD bn	
Taiwan	4,375	4,686	(39.0)
India	245	1,566	(24.6)
Indonesia	(30)	9	(4.2)
Philippines	(57)	(72)	(0.2)
Malaysia	(108)	(215)	(0.8)
Thailand	(28)	(299)	2.0
Brazil	(1,239)	(2,328)	4.4
Korea	2,084	(2,959)	(104.0)
China	(4,483)	(5,750)	14.9

Source: Bloomberg, national sources, IIF, Standard Chartered Research

Figure 7: Cross-asset comparison of EM debt and equities (weekly)

Foreign investors turned net sellers of local bonds, and bought EM equities

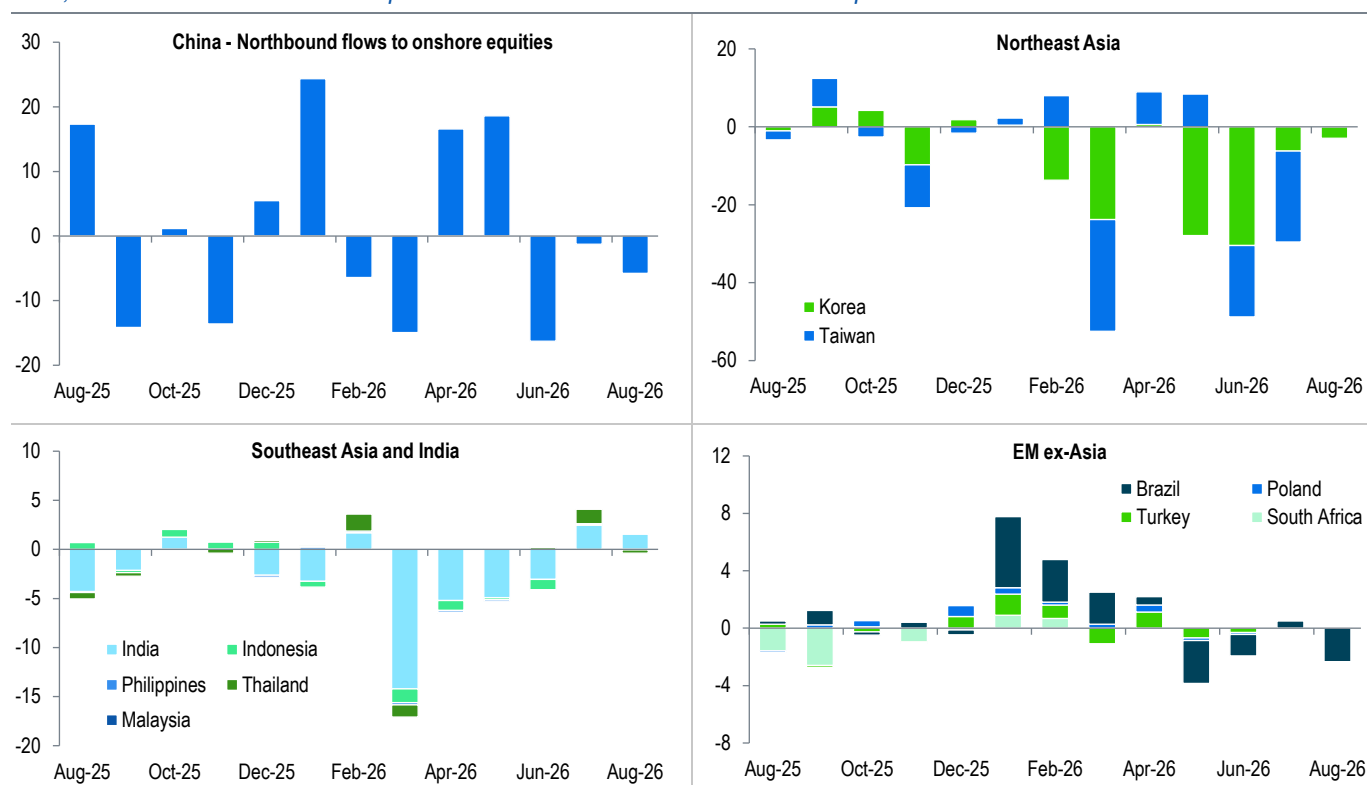


*Note: The latest data is WTD, based on the latest available data as shown in Figures 5 and 6; Source: Bloomberg, national sources, IIF, Standard Chartered Research

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Figure 8: Regional equity flows (monthly, USD bn)

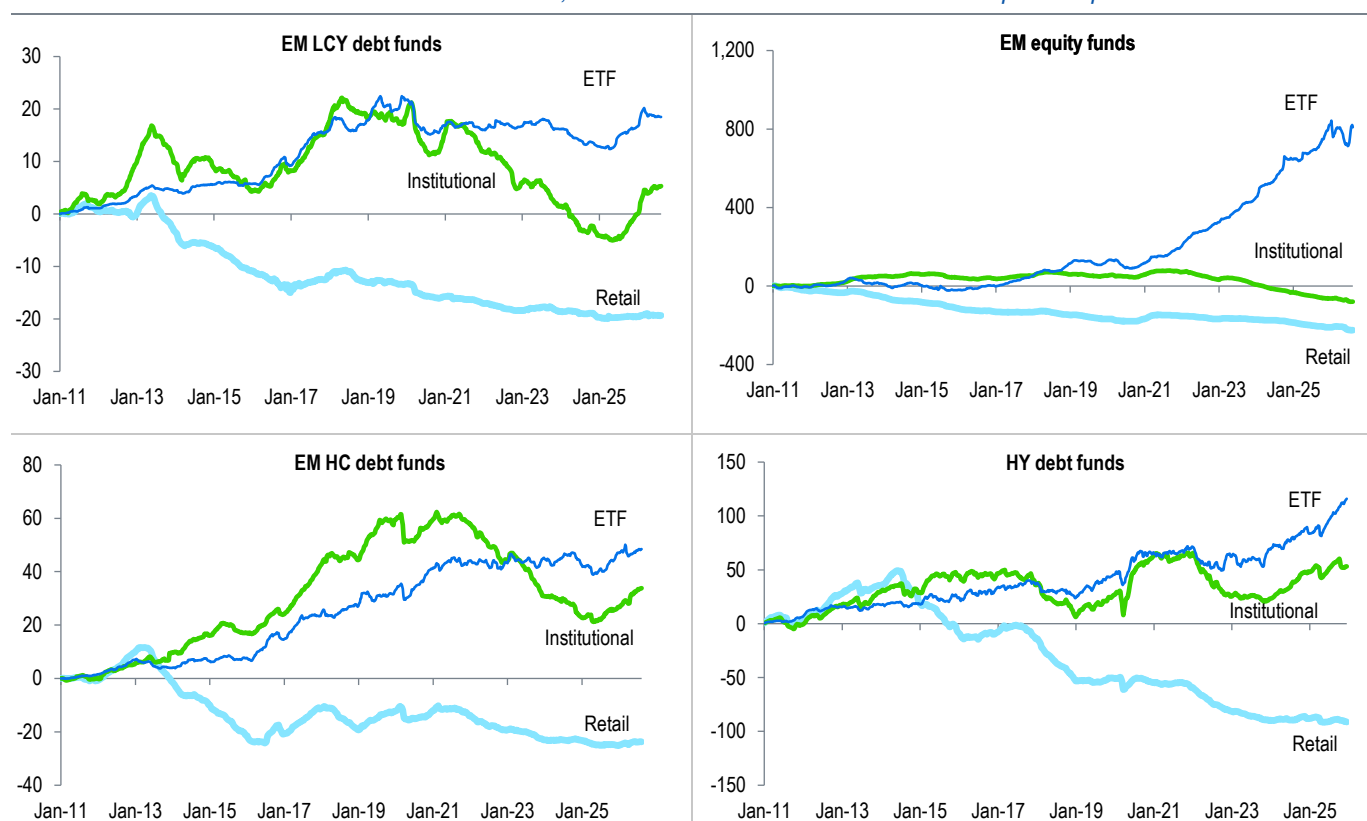
MTD, most North Asian and BRL equities have witnessed outflows while INR equities have seen continued inflows



Source: Bloomberg, national sources, IIF, Standard Chartered Research

Figure 9: Cumulative flows into equity and debt funds by investor type (USD bn)

ETFs continue to lead inflows to most asset classes; investment in EM institutional funds has picked up



Source: EPFR, Standard Chartered Research



Appendix – Flow data defined

EM hard-currency (HC) fund flows: Weekly flows to funds classified by EPFR Global as having a geographical focus on 'Global Emerging Markets' within the HC division of Emerging Market Debt funds. There are about 360 'HC' funds with AUM of about USD 186bn. In general, a significant part of the variation in HC fund flows is driven by the variation in flows to a small number of large (in AUM terms) ETFs; this is not the case for local or blended funds.

EM local-currency (LCY) and blended-currency (BC) fund flows: Weekly flows to funds classified by EPFR Global as having a geographical focus on 'Global Emerging Markets' (GEM) within the LCY or BC divisions of EM debt funds. There are about 180 'LCY' funds with AUM of about USD 71bn and nearly 130 'BC' funds with AUM of around USD 46bn.

EM equity fund flows: Weekly flows to funds classified by EPFR Global as being focused on Emerging Market Equities. There are about 4,100 of these funds with total AUM of about USD 1.5tn. Of which, equity funds focused on Global Emerging Markets (USD 735bn), China (USD 362bn) and Asia ex-Japan (USD 165bn) account for more than 80% of total AUM across EM equity funds.

Foreign flows to EM LCY debt markets: We cover the larger markets (by index weight) in the J.P. Morgan Global Bond Index – Emerging Markets Global Diversified (GBI-EMGD). Foreign flow data for Asia includes Indonesian government bonds, Malaysian Government Securities and Thailand government instruments.

Thai data is provided by the Thailand Bond Market Association at daily frequency, with no lag for non-resident net purchases of Thailand bonds; the data aggregates government bonds, treasury bills, state enterprise bonds, savings bonds, commercial paper, corporate bonds and foreign bonds. This data shows similar flow dynamics to the Bank of Thailand aggregate monthly data on non-resident net purchases of government t bonds and of Bank of Thailand bonds, so we use it as a proxy for all Thai government instruments.

For Latin America, we include Brazil's fixed-rate government bonds only; these account for around 85% of the total held by foreigners, as only fixed-rate bonds are GBI-EMGD-eligible. We also include data on Mexico's treasury bonds (Bonos) only, which account for around two-thirds of government debt held by foreigners, but not treasury bills (Cetes).

For Eastern Europe and Africa, the foreign flow data includes Polish government bonds, Hungarian treasury bonds, Russian government bonds, South African treasury bonds, Egyptian Treasury bills and Turkish government bonds.



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	Standard Chartered terminology	Impact	Definition
Issuer recommendation	Overweight	Outperform	We expect the credit spreads of the issuer's bond complex to <IMPACT> in comparison to other issuers in the relevant Bloomberg index over the next 6 months
	Market weight	Perform in line	
	Underweight	Underperform	

Previous recommendation structure – Credit (effective prior to 13 July 2020)

	Standard Chartered terminology	Impact	Definition
Issuer - Credit outlook	Positive	Improve	We expect the fundamental credit profile of the issuer to <IMPACT> over the next 12 months
	Stable	Remain stable	
	Negative	Deteriorate	

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	Standard Chartered terminology	Impact	Definition
Issuer recommendation	Positive	Outperform	We expect the total return of the issuer's local-currency bond complex in USD terms to <IMPACT> in comparison to other issuers under our coverage* over the next 3 months
	Neutral	Perform in line	
	Defensive [^]	Underperform	

*See <https://research.sc.com/research/api/application/static/forecasts#rates> for our full rates coverage universe and current recommendations.

[^]As of 9 November 2024, Defensive outlook replaces Negative outlook.

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Document approved by

Nagaraj Kulkarni

Chief Rates Strategist, South Asia & Indonesia, and Head, Flows Strategy

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